Text 1

第 1 段

Among the annoying challenges facing the middle class is one that will probably go unmentioned in the next presidential campaign: What happens when the robots come for their jobs?

直译：中产阶级面临的种种令人烦恼的挑战中，有一个问题很可能在下一次总统竞选中无人提及：当机器人来抢他们的工作时，会发生什么？

第 2 段

Don't dismiss that possibility entirely. About half of U.S. jobs are at high risk of being automated, according to a University of Oxford study, with the middle class disproportionately squeezed. Lower-income jobs like gardening or day care don't appeal to robots. But many middle-class occupations —trucking, financial advice, software engineering —have aroused their interest, or soon will. The rich own the robots, so they will be fine.

直译：不要完全排除这种可能。牛津大学的一项研究显示，美国约有一半的工作面临被自动化取代的高度风险，而中产阶级承受的挤压尤为严重。园艺或日间托育等低收入工作并不能吸引机器人。但许多中产阶级职业——卡车运输、财务咨询、软件工程——已经引起机器人的兴趣，或者很快就会如此。富人拥有机器人，所以他们不会有事。

第 3 段

This isn't to be alarmist. Optimists point out that technological upheaval has benefited workers in the past. The Industrial Revolution didn't go so well for Luddites whose jobs were displaced by mechanized looms, but it eventually raised living standards and created more jobs than it destroyed. Likewise, automation should eventually boost productivity, stimulate demand by driving down prices, and free workers from hard, boring work. But in the medium term, middle-class workers may need a lot of help adjusting.

直译：这并不是危言耸听。乐观者指出，过去技术的剧烈变革曾使劳动者受益。对那些工作被机械织布机取代的卢德派工人来说，工业革命并不那么美好，但它最终提高了生活水平，而且创造的工作岗位多于摧毁的岗位。同样，自动化最终应当能够提高生产率，通过压低价格刺激需求，并把劳动者从艰苦、乏味的工作中解放出来。但从中期来看，中产阶级劳动者在适应过程中可能需要很多帮助。

第 4 段

The first step, as Erik Brynjolfsson and Andrew McAfee argue in The Second Machine Age, should be rethinking education and job training. Curriculums —from grammar school to college —should evolve to focus less on memorizing facts and more on creativity and complex communication. Vocational schools should do a better job of fostering problem-solving skills and helping students work alongside robots. Online education can supplement the traditional kind. It could make extra training and instruction affordable. Professionals trying to acquire new skills will be able to do so without going into debt.

直译：正如埃里克·布林约尔松与安德鲁·麦卡菲在《第二次机器革命》中所主张的，第一步应当是重新思考教育和职业培训。从小学到大学的课程，都应逐渐减少对事实记忆的重视，而更多关注创造力和复杂沟通能力。职业学校应当在培养解决问题的能力、帮助学生与机器人协同工作方面做得更好。在线教育可以补充传统教育，它可以使额外培训与教学变得负担得起。试图掌握新技能的专业人士，将能够在不背上债务的情况下做到这一点。

第 5 段

The challenge of coping with automation underlines the need for the U.S. to revive its fading business dynamism: Starting new companies must be made easier. In previous eras of drastic technological change, entrepreneurs smoothed the transition by dreaming up ways to combine labor and machines. The best uses of 3D printers and virtual reality haven't been invented yet. The U.S. needs the new companies that will invent them.

直译：应对自动化的挑战，凸显了美国重振日渐衰退的商业活力的必要性：创办新公司必须变得更容易。在以往技术剧烈变革的时代，企业家通过想出把劳动力与机器结合起来的方式，使转型更加平稳。三维打印机和虚拟现实的最佳用途尚未被发明出来。美国需要能够发明这些用途的新公司。

第 6 段

Finally, because automation threatens to widen the gap between capital income and labor income, taxes and the safety net will have to be rethought. Taxes on low-wage labor need to be cut, and wage subsidies such as the earned income tax credit should be expanded: This would boost incomes, encourage work, reward companies for job creation, and reduce inequality.

直译：最后，由于自动化可能扩大资本收入与劳动收入之间的差距，税收和社会保障体系也必须重新考虑。需要减轻低薪劳动者的税负，并扩大劳动所得税收抵免之类的工资补贴：这将提高收入、鼓励工作、奖励创造就业岗位的企业，并减少不平等。

第 7 段

Technology will improve society in ways big and small over the next few years, yet this will be little comfort to those who find their lives and careers upended by automation. Destroying the machines that are coming for our jobs would be nuts. But policies to help workers adapt will be indispensable.

直译：未来几年，技术会以各种大大小小的方式改善社会，但对于那些生活与职业被自动化彻底打乱的人来说，这几乎不能带来安慰。毁掉那些前来夺走我们工作的机器，会是愚蠢之举。但是，帮助劳动者适应的政策将不可或缺。

Text 2

第 1 段

A new survey by Harvard University finds more than two-thirds of young Americans disapprove of President Trump's use of Twitter. The implication is that Millennials prefer news from the White House to be filtered through other sources, not a president's social media platform.

直译：哈佛大学的一项新调查发现，超过三分之二的美国年轻人不赞成特朗普总统使用推特。这意味着，千禧一代更希望白宫新闻经由其他来源筛选后传来，而不是来自总统的社交媒体平台。

第 2 段

Most Americans rely on social media to check daily headlines. Yet as distrust has risen toward all media, people may be starting to beef up their media literacy skills. Such a trend is badly needed. During the 2016 presidential campaign, nearly a quarter of web content shared by Twitter users in the politically critical state of Michigan was fake news, according to the University of Oxford. And a survey conducted for BuzzFeed News found 44 percent of Facebook users rarely or never trust news from the media giant.

直译：大多数美国人依靠社交媒体查看每日新闻头条。然而，随着人们对所有媒体的不信任上升，他们可能开始提升自己的媒介素养。这种趋势迫切需要出现。牛津大学的研究显示，在二〇一六年总统竞选期间，在政治上至关重要的密歇根州，推特用户分享的网络内容中，近四分之一是假新闻。而为 BuzzFeed 新闻所作的一项调查发现，百分之四十四的脸书用户很少或从不信任这家媒体巨头上的新闻。

第 3 段

Young people who are digital natives are indeed becoming more skillful at separating fact from fiction in cyberspace. A Knight Foundation focus-group survey of young people between ages 14 and 24 found they use "distributed trust" to verify stories. They cross-check sources and prefer news from different perspectives —especially those that are open about any bias. "Many young people assume a great deal of personal responsibility for educating themselves and actively seeking out opposing viewpoints," the survey concluded.

直译：作为数字原住民的年轻人，在网络空间区分事实与虚构方面，确实变得更加熟练。奈特基金会对十四至二十四岁年轻人开展的一项焦点小组调查发现，他们通过“分散式信任”来核实报道。他们交叉核对不同来源，偏好来自不同视角的新闻，尤其偏好那些公开说明自身偏见的来源。调查得出结论：“许多年轻人承担了很大的个人责任，主动教育自己，并积极寻找相反的观点。”

第 4 段

Such active research can have another effect. A 2014 survey conducted in Australia, Britain, and the United States by the University of Wisconsin-Madison found that young people's reliance on social media led to greater political engagement.

直译：这种主动查证还可能产生另一种效果。威斯康星大学麦迪逊分校于二〇一四年在澳大利亚、英国和美国开展的一项调查发现，年轻人对社交媒体的依赖，促成了更高程度的政治参与。

第 5 段

Social media allows users to experience news events more intimately and immediately while also permitting them to re-share news as a projection of their values and interests. This forces users to be more conscious of their role in passing along information. A survey by Barna research group found the top reason given by Americans for the fake news phenomenon is “reader error,” more so than made-up stories or factual mistakes in reporting. About a third say the problem of fake news lies in “misinterpretation or exaggeration of actual news” via social media. In other words, the choice to share news on social media may be the heart of the issue. “This indicates there is a real personal responsibility in counteracting this problem,” says Roxanne Stone, editor in chief at Barna Group.

直译：社交媒体让用户能够更贴近、更即时地体验新闻事件，同时也允许他们再次分享新闻，以表达自己的价值观和兴趣。这迫使用户更加意识到自己在传播信息中扮演的角色。巴纳研究集团的一项调查发现，美国人认为假新闻现象的首要原因是“读者错误”，其重要性超过编造的报道或报道中的事实错误。约三分之一的人说，假新闻的问题在于通过社交媒体“误解或夸大真实新闻”。换句话说，是否选择在社交媒体上分享新闻，可能才是问题的核心。巴纳集团主编罗克珊·斯通说：“这表明，在抵制这一问题方面，个人确实负有责任。”

第 6 段

So when young people are critical of an over-tweeting president, they reveal a mental discipline in thinking skills —and in their choices on when to share on social media.

直译：所以，当年轻人批评一个过度发推文的总统时，他们展现了思维能力上的自我约束，也展现了在选择何时于社交媒体上分享内容方面的自我约束。

Text 3

第 1 段

Any fair-minded assessment of the dangers of the deal between Britain's National Health Service (NHS) and DeepMind must start by acknowledging that both sides mean well. DeepMind is one of the leading artificial intelligence (AI) companies in the world. The potential of this work applied to healthcare is very great, but it could also lead to further concentration of power in the tech giants. It is against that background that the information commissioner, Elizabeth Denham, has issued her damning verdict against the Royal Free hospital trust under the NHS, which handed over to DeepMind the records of 1.6 million patients in 2015 on the basis of a vague agreement which took far too little account of the patients' rights and their expectations of privacy.

直译：任何对英国国民医疗服务体系（NHS）与 DeepMind 之间交易风险的公正评估，都必须首先承认双方的出发点都是好的。DeepMind 是全球领先的人工智能（AI）公司之一。把这项工作应用于医疗保健的潜力非常大，但它也可能导致权力进一步集中于科技巨头。正是在这一背景下，信息专员伊丽莎白 · 德纳姆对 NHS 下属的皇家自由医院信托机构作出了严厉谴责的裁定。该机构于二〇一五年根据一份含糊的协议，把一百六十万名患者的记录交给 DeepMind，而这份协议对患者的权利及其隐私期待考虑得远远不够。

第 2 段

DeepMind has almost apologized. The NHS trust has mended its ways. Further arrangements —and there may be many —between the NHS and DeepMind will be carefully scrutinised to ensure that all necessary permissions have been asked of patients and all unnecessary data has been cleaned. There are lessons about informed patient consent to learn. But privacy is not the only angle in this case and not even the most important. Ms Denham chose to concentrate the blame on the NHS trust, since under existing law it "controlled" the data and DeepMind merely "processed" it. But this distinction misses the point that it is processing and aggregation, not the mere possession of bits, that gives the data value.

直译：DeepMind 几乎已经算是道了歉。NHS 的这家信托机构也改正了做法。NHS 与 DeepMind 之间后续的安排——可能还有很多——都将受到仔细审查，以确保已向患者征求一切必要许可，并已清除一切不必要的数据。在患者知情同意方面，有教训需要吸取。但隐私并不是此案唯一的角度，甚至不是最重要的角度。德纳姆女士选择把责备集中于 NHS 信托机构，因为依据现行法律，该机构 " 控制 " 数据，而 DeepMind 只是 " 处理 " 数据。但是，这种区分遗漏了一个要点：赋予数据价值的，是处理与汇总，而不仅仅是占有数据比特。

第 3 段

The great question is who should benefit from the analysis of all the data that our lives now generate. Privacy law builds on the concept of damage to an individual from identifiable knowledge about them. That misses the way the surveillance economy works. The data of an individual there gains its value only when it is compared with the data of countless millions more.

直译：重大问题在于：如今我们的生活产生的全部数据，经过分析之后，究竟应该由谁获益？隐私法建立在这样一个概念之上：能够识别个人身份的信息，会给该个人造成损害。但这一思路遗漏了监控经济的运作方式。在这种经济中，个人的数据只有与另外数以百万计的人的数据比较时，才获得价值。

第 4 段

The use of privacy law to curb the tech giants in this instance feels slightly maladapted. This practice does not address the real worry. It is not enough to say that the algorithms DeepMind develops will benefit patients and save lives. What matters is that they will belong to a private monopoly which developed them using public resources. If software promises to save lives on the scale that drugs now can, big data may be expected to behave as a big pharma has done. We are still at the beginning of this revolution and small choices now may turn out to have gigantic consequences later. A long struggle will be needed to avoid a future of digital feudalism. Ms Denham's report is a welcome start.

直译：在这个案例中，使用隐私法来约束科技巨头，似乎有些不太对路。这种做法没有处理真正令人担忧的问题。仅仅说 DeepMind 开发的算法将使患者受益、挽救生命，是不够的。关键在于，这些算法将属于一家利用公共资源开发它们的私人垄断企业。如果软件有望像如今的药物一样大规模挽救生命，那么大数据行业可能会像大型制药业那样行事。我们仍处于这场革命的开端，如今微小的选择，日后可能产生巨大的后果。要避免一个数字封建主义的未来，需要长期斗争。德纳姆女士的报告，是一个值得欢迎的开端。

Text 4

第 1 段

The U.S. Postal Service (USPS) continues to bleed red ink. It reported a net loss of $5.6 billion for fiscal 2016, the 10th straight year its expenses have exceeded revenue. Meanwhile, it has more than $120 billion in unfunded liabilities, mostly for employee health and retirement costs. There are many reasons this formerly stable federal institution finds itself at the brink of bankruptcy. Fundamentally, the USPS is in a historic squeeze between technological change that has permanently decreased demand for its bread-and-butter product, first-class mail, and a regulatory structure that denies management the flexibility to adjust its operations to the new reality.

直译：美国邮政局（USPS）继续出现赤字。它报告称，二〇一六财年的净亏损为五十六亿美元，这是其支出连续第十年超过收入。与此同时，它还有超过一千二百亿美元的未获资金支持的负债，大部分用于员工医疗与退休费用。这一曾经稳定的联邦机构如今发现自己处于破产边缘，原因有很多。从根本上说，USPS 正受到两方面的历史性挤压：一方面，技术变革永久性地降低了人们对其主要收入来源——一类邮件——的需求；另一方面，监管结构使管理层缺乏调整业务、适应新现实的灵活性。

第 2 段

And interest groups ranging from postal unions to greeting-card makers exert self-interested pressure on the USPS's ultimate overseer —Congress —insisting that whatever else happens to the Postal Service, aspects of the status quo they depend on get protected. This is why repeated attempts at reform legislation have failed in recent years, leaving the Postal Service unable to pay its bills except by deferring vital modernization.

直译：而从邮政工会到贺卡制造商的各类利益集团，出于自身利益，向 USPS 的最终监管者——国会——施压，坚持要求无论邮政局发生其他什么变化，它们赖以生存的现状都必须受到保护。这就是近年来多次改革立法尝试失败的原因，也使邮政局除了推迟至关重要的现代化建设之外，无法支付账单。

第 3 段

Now comes word that everyone involved —Democrats, Republicans, the Postal Service, the unions and the system's heaviest users —has finally agreed on a plan to fix the system. Legislation is moving through the House that would save USPS an estimated $28.6 billion over five years, which could help pay for new vehicles, among other survival measures. Most of the money would come from a penny-per-letter permanent rate increase and from shifting postal retirees into Medicare. The latter step would largely offset the financial burden of annually pre-funding retiree health care, thus addressing a long-standing complaint by the USPS and its unions.

直译：如今有消息传来，所有相关各方——民主党、共和党、邮政局、工会，以及该系统最大的用户——终于就修复这一系统的计划达成一致。有关立法正在众议院推进，预计将在五年内为 USPS 节省二百八十六亿美元。这笔钱可以帮助购买新车辆，并采取其他维持生存的措施。大部分资金将来自每封信永久提价一美分，以及让邮政退休人员转入联邦医疗保险。后一项措施将大幅抵消每年预先为退休人员医疗保健筹资的财务负担，从而回应 USPS 及其工会长期以来的一项抱怨。

第 4 段

If it clears the House, this measure would still have to get through the Senate —where someone is bound to point out that it amounts to the bare, bare minimum necessary to keep the Postal Service afloat, not comprehensive reform. There's no change to collective bargaining at the USPS, a major omission considering that personnel accounts for 80 percent of the agency's costs. Also missing is any discussion of eliminating Saturday letter delivery. That common-sense change enjoys wide public support and would save the USPS $2 billion per year. But postal special-interest groups seem to have killed it, at least in the House. The emerging consensus around the bill is a sign that legislators are getting frightened about a politically embarrassing short-term collapse at the USPS. It is not, however, a sign that they're getting serious about transforming the postal system for the 21st century.

直译：如果这项措施在众议院获得通过，它仍须通过参议院；在那里，必定有人指出，它只不过是维持邮政局运转所需的最低、最低限度的措施，而不是全面改革。它没有改变 USPS 的集体谈判制度；考虑到人事费用占该机构成本的百分之八十，这是一项重大遗漏。同样缺失的，还有关于取消星期六信件投递的任何讨论。这一符合常理的改变获得公众广泛支持，而且每年可为 USPS 节省二十亿美元。但邮政特殊利益集团似乎已经扼杀了它，至少在众议院是如此。围绕该法案正在形成的共识表明，立法者开始害怕 USPS 在短期内倒闭，造成政治上的难堪。然而，这并不表明他们正在认真着手把邮政系统改造成适应二十一世纪的体系。